

Roguelike Elements

Procedurally Generated Levels:

- Galaxy, Solar System, and Planets could be procedurally generated to offer a variety
- Partial: Some solar systems are “baked in,” offering waypoints and storyhooks
 - Systems could be generated between these story points to offer surprise planets, encounters, or upgrade opportunities

Upgrading + Permadeath:

- Your crew represents permanent upgrades? Sorta.
- Or your crew can be killed, and all upgrades lost?
 - Crew like XCOM, can be recruited, upgraded, etc.
 - Can be permanently killed
 - *Scouts* - higher chance to find stuff, better detection, maybe a threat radar, etc
 - *Engineers* - higher chance to find supplies, build stuff for cheaper, repair
 - *Excavators* - faster at digging, larger cargo storage, etc.
- Same with exploration ships?
 - Can be temporarily upgraded on planetary runs. At end of run, all ship progress is reset
 - Can permanently upgrade hull / gun strength, storage, shields, thrusters, etc.
- Main vessel can be permanently upgraded
 - Think mobile base. Hold more / better crew, more / better ships, automate construction / refining, break down hauls, tow larger ships, on-site processing, etc.

Turn-Based Gameplay:

- Overworld Map - perhaps there is a race-against-time element where moving squares costs time
 - Objectives will need to be filled by a certain time
 - Ships may explode, survivors will stop surviving, etc.
 - Prize money or loot may be forfeited
 - Encourages player to manage time, choose to let some things go to pursue other goals
 - Encourages player to upgrade ship to hold more fuel or buy stronger engines
- Not necessarily “turn based” against an enemy, but moreso the environment

Unforgiving Difficulty:

- Player decisions hold weight, and mistakes can be costly
- Resources like health, repair packs, and weapons must be managed carefully to survive

Grid-Based Movement:

- Characters / enemies move and interact within a grid system.
- Adds a layer of strategy where the player must position themselves to
 - attack

- defend
- navigate environments

Resource Management:

- Players must balance fuel, power, life support, resources, materials, supplies
 - Fuel makes the starship move
 - Power runs starship systems
 - Life support let's crew breathe and not freeze
 - Resources - currency
 - Materials - allow for upgrades, advancements
 - Supplies keep the crew fed and watered. Medical / repair supplies

Limited Information & Exploration (Fog of War):

- Player must work to unlock information about the world around them
 - Encourages player to spend resources to upgrade information-gathering
 - Wider site range
 - Radar minimap

Focus on Loot + Character Builds:

- Planets will offer temporary upgrades to increase player survivability
- Resources can be spent to permanently upgrade staff / ships

High Replayability:

- Procedural generation will change the levels a player encounters on each playthrough
- Tech trees or Upgrades can be varied, along with ships or player classes
- Player can be encouraged to use a variety of strategies to progress through the game

USG Specific Goals:

Levels of Scope:

- Ark
- Solar System
 - Possible Intrasystem Travel minigame?
- POI

Ship Reconstruction Goals:

- Find the actual facility / pieces of facility
 - Least Expensive
 - Most Effective
- Find the personnel with knowledge of the facility
 - Cheaper
 - Less Effective
- Brute Force construction of new facility
 - More Expensive

- Less Effective

Ship Sections:

- Bio Farm
 - Hydroponics Bay (agriculture)
 - Aquaponics Section (fish)
 - Genetics Lab (mutants)
- Factory
 - Manufacturing Bay (tools, spares, 3D printers, etc)
 - Recycling Plant (process waste materials)
 - Robotics (Maintenance Bots / Drones / Repair Droids)
- Medical Wing
 - Infirmary (basic medical facilities)
 - Biolab (advanced research)
 - Cryogenic Storage (long-term stasis)
- Living Quarters
 - Crew Cabins
 - Communal Areas (recreation, relaxation, destress)
 - Sanitation Facilities (bathrooms, laundry)
- Command Center
 - Bridge
 - War Room
 - Data Core
- Engineering
 - Engine Room
 - Maintenance
 - Fuel Storage
- Scientific Research Facilities
 - Astrophysics Lab
 - Biology Lab
 - Materials Lab
- Cargo Hold
 - Storage Bays
 - Hanger
- Environmental Control / Life Support
 - Water Treatment Plant
 - Air Filtration System
 - Temperature Regulation
- Cultural / Recreational Areas
 - Library / Archive
 - Holodeck / VR room
 - Art Gallery / Theater

Environments / Biomes:

- Mechanical (Factory / Replicator)
- Radioactive / Warped (Core / Warp Drive)

- Vegetative (Biofarms / Meat Generators)
- Armored (Combat Drones / Armored Devices)
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Classifications:

- Stars
 - O - Blue
 - B - Blue-White
 - A - White
 - F - Yellow-White
 - G - Yellow
 - K - Orange
 - M - Red
- Planets
- Astroid Belts
- Satellites
 - Natural
 - Artificial
- Orphans
 - Natural
 - Artificial
- Anomalous

Non-Combat Hazards:

- Environmental
 - Fire
 - Poison / lack of oxygen
 - Extreme temperatures
 - Infections
 - Radiation
- Psychological

Food for Thought:

- Replayability
 - Faster times
 - Curiosity (Hidden Secrets)
- Incentives and Rewards
 - New Moves
 - Deeper Lore
 - Alternative Approaches
- View Game Elements as Promises
 - Doors promise new areas or secrets
 - NPCs promise new encounters or dialogue options
 - New games frequently break these promises
- Endless Mastery
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- Speedrunning
- Intertwined Mechanics
 - Action options / skills that interact with each other